

Inflated Facts

- People were paid by the hour and rushed to pass money to loved ones so that it could be spent before its value meant it was worthless.
- People had to shop with wheel barrows full of money
- Bartering became common – exchanging something for something else but not accepting money for it. Bartering had been common in Medieval times!
- Pensioners on fixed incomes suffered as pensions became worthless.
- Restaurants did not print menus as by the time food arrive...the price had gone up!
- The poor became even poorer and the winter of 1923 meant that many lived in freezing conditions burning furniture to get some heat.
- The very rich suffered least because they had sufficient contacts to get food etc. Most of the very rich were land owners and could produce food on their own estates.
- The group that suffered a great deal – proportional to their income – was the middle class. Their hard earned savings disappeared overnight. They did not have the wealth or land to fall back on as the rich had. Many middle class families had to sell family heirlooms to survive.
- *Dawes Plan* stabilizes Germany through creating a new currency & borrowing heavily from the US. No problem here in 1924 right?

The Good Ole Days

